

Auction Gap Tracker

Indicators & Analysis / Order Flow & Auction | advanced | 4 min read | DeepCharts Help Center | August 24, 2026

The Auction Gap Tracker identifies gaps in the auction process — areas on the chart where there is a lack of participation from buyers or sellers — and highlights those imbalances with colored rectangles. Where Unfinished Auction focuses on anomalies at bar extremes, this tool tracks zero prints and near-zero participation anywhere you configure it to look, including inside bars.

This is an advanced order-flow tool: it assumes you understand aggressive buying and selling at the Bid and Ask. If you need the foundations, start with Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta and Understanding Auction Theory: Imbalance, Unfinished Auctions, Absorption.

What it is

At price levels where one side of the tape traded nothing (a zero print) or almost nothing, the auction skipped a step — participation was missing. The Auction Gap Tracker scans for runs of such levels and, when enough consecutive ones appear, draws a rectangle marking the buy-side or sell-side gap. When price later crosses a highlighted level, the opacity of the highlight decreases, indicating the level has been crossed.

To see what a zero print looks like inside a bar, hover the bid×ask cells in the interactive footprint below:

[WIDGET: footprint-lab]

When to use it

- To map low-participation areas that price may revisit to complete the auction.
- To track zero prints inside bars, not only at highs and lows.
- To separate untested gaps from gaps that have already been retested (triggered zones).
- To receive a sound alert when a new gap is detected.

Quick start

1. Add **Auction Gap Tracker** to your chart.
2. Start strict: keep **Threshold-max. unfinished** at 0 so only true zero prints are tracked.
3. Set **Min. Num. Of Consecutive Zero** to require a run of levels — for example, 5 highlights only areas with five or more consecutive price levels lacking an aggressive side.
4. Choose your **Include Mode**: **Intrabar** to ignore highs and lows, or **All** to track every qualifying gap.
5. Pick distinct buy and sell colors, and enable the triggered-zone display if you want retested gaps kept on the chart.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] A chart with the Auction Gap Tracker active, showing a fully opaque sell-side gap rectangle extending right and a reduced-opacity rectangle where price has already crossed the level

`auction-gap-tracker-zones-chart.png`

How to read it

Each rectangle marks a run of price levels where one side of the market failed to participate. A buy-side gap means aggressive buyers were absent through those levels; a sell-side gap means aggressive sellers were. Auction logic treats these as incomplete areas the market may revisit — similar to unfinished business at an extreme, but detectable anywhere in the bar.

Opacity is the state indicator: full opacity means the gap is untouched since detection, while reduced opacity means price has crossed the level at least once. With **Enable Triggered Zone** on, crossed gaps remain visible in their trigger colors; with **Trigger Only Touch** enabled, only gaps that have been retested at least

once are plotted.

Settings reference

Unfinished Settings

Setting	What it does
Minimum Tick Vol	The minimum volume required on ticks where the zero occurs.
Threshold-max. unfinished	Maximum threshold for Unfinished tracking. 0 tracks only zero prints; 1 also tracks levels where only 1 contract traded on the Ask or Bid side, and so on.
Include Mode	Intrabar tracks Unfinished only within bars, excluding highs and lows; All tracks every Unfinished level meeting your parameters.
Min. Num. Of Consecutive Zero	Minimum number of consecutive zeros required to trigger a highlight — for example, 5 highlights only runs of five or more consecutive price levels lacking aggressive buyers or sellers.

Plot Settings

Setting	What it does
Num. Extended Bars	How many bars forward the indicator's lines extend.
Line Width	Thickness of the lines.
Buy Color / Sell Color	Colors for buy-side and sell-side gaps.
Enable Triggered Zone	When enabled, also plots gaps that price has already retested.
Trigger Only Touch	When enabled, plots only gaps that have been retested at least once.
Buy Trig Color / Sell Trig Color	Colors for crossed (triggered) Unfinished zones.

Alert Settings

Sound alerts for generated signals. configurable by the user.

[SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER] The Auction Gap Tracker settings dialog showing the Unfinished Settings group with Minimum Tick Vol, Threshold-max. unfinished, Include Mode and Min. Num. Of Consecutive Zero
auction-gap-tracker-settings-dialog.png

Tips and common mistakes

- **Raise the threshold deliberately.** Moving **Threshold-max. unfinished** above 0 redefines what counts as a gap — from true zero prints to thin participation. Know which definition your strategy relies on.
- **Consecutive zeros are the noise filter.** Isolated zero prints are routine; runs of them are the signal. Increase **Min. Num. Of Consecutive Zero** if the chart fills with trivial highlights.
- **Choose Include Mode consciously.** **Intrabar** deliberately excludes highs and lows — if you want extreme-based unfinished auctions too, use **All** or pair this tool with Unfinished Auction.
- **Read opacity before acting.** A faded rectangle has already been crossed; its information content is different from an untouched gap.

Related articles

- Understanding Auction Theory: Imbalance, Unfinished Auctions, Absorption

- Unfinished Auction
- Imbalance Tracker
- Orderflow 101: Bid, Ask, Aggressor and Delta
- Different Types of Input Data for Indicators
- How to Change the Layout of Indicators